give me a chance (to say what I mean)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47205130.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Perfuma (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Mara (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Modern Etheria (She-Ra), Firefighter AU, no actual fires though, background scorfuma, alcohol use, Drunk Catra, mentions of marijuana use, Fluff and Crack, ridiculous plotlines, Based off a video, neither an exes or fake marriage AU but something in between, this is a romcom at best, no sexual content but lots of sexual innuendos, Firefighter Adora (She-Ra)

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by sunstardust

Summary

"How the fuck do you know my name?" she shot out before she even had a chance to think the logic through, and then she froze when she saw their face.

"And why the *fuck* do you look like my ex?"

The firefighter — the woman, the golden-haired *goddess* standing next to her in a t-shirt so fitted to her muscles it should have been illegal and the ugliest pants she'd ever seen do such wonders for someone's thighs, with soft, pale skin and a sloped nose and eyes so blue she couldn't believe they were real — blinked down at her in surprise.

"Your ex?" she asked, her head tilting ever so slightly to the side like a confused puppy.

-

When Catra has to call for help with a jammed door in the middle of the night, the last thing she's expecting is for one of the firefighters who arrives to look uncannily like someone she used to know. It's not until the next morning when she's sober and distanced from it that she realizes the woman didn't just look *like* Adora — it *was* Adora.

Notes

This idea came from a video that I'll link in the end notes, and is probably the most ridiculous thing I've ever written. The title is a lyric from I Want To Be With You by chloe moriondo. Enjoy and HAPPY ANNIVERSARY CATRADORA!

See the end of the work for more notes

9 1 1, what is your emergency?

"Uh. *Fuck,*" Catra cursed, the call taker's urgent voice fueling the panic inside her head. "My friend, uh, she's trapped in the bathroom. My bathroom. In my house. I can't get the door open; we need help."

"Is your friend safe inside?"

"I think so? I don't know. She's fucking *wasted,* so she's not responding, but I think she's still conscious."

Mm. Catra listened as the noise of quick typing carried across the phone line. "And are *you* safe?"

"Me? Yeah, I'm fine. Except that my fucking bathroom door won't open, and *my friend is stuck inside!*"

"I understand. We're going to get you some help. What's your name and address?"

Catra prattled off the information, her voice strangled in the rhythm of the familiar words.

"Alright, Catra, emergency services are on their way"—

"Wait! Who did you send?! Don't send the cops, *please* don't send the cops."

"The fire department is on its way. Depending on what they find, they might have to call the cops"—

"*No* cops!"—

"The fire department is just around the corner, Catra. Do you hear the sirens yet?"

As if on a perfect cue, the distant wail of a fire truck filtered into the house.

The first ounce of relief Catra had felt since she tried to unlock the bathroom door and felt the lock jam instead finally crept into her body. They were going to be okay.

Catra was standing in her front doorway, biting nervously at one of her claws while she watched three different firefighters all attend to Perfuma on the front lawn. A large scorpioni was speaking directly to her, while a short woman with pink and purple hair and tall, kind-faced man seemed to be doing a physical exam. She was safe, thank goodness, but she was still crossed out of her mind and *very* confused about what had happened.

The firefighters had been gracious enough not to call the cops, but they refused to leave without assessing if she needed any medical assistance. Catra was glad they were doing their job, but this was not how she'd wanted the night to go. This was *not* what she'd had in mind when she promised to throw Perfuma a break-up party.

"She'll be alright," a soft, hopeful voice of f to the right offered her.

Catra glanced over just enough to see the telltale ugly blue utility pants of one of the firefighters, and she turned slightly away. All of them had been nice enough, and very efficient, but she knew they were judging her for getting into this situation. As if it was her fucking fault that this happened.

Well.

t *was* her fucking fault that this happened.

That's why it sucked so hard.

"Good," she replied tightly . "I'm glad."

"Y ou did the right thing, calling for help. There isn't a shoulder in the world that could have broken that door down. You needed us."

"And you showed up just in time," Catra sniped back, crueler than she wanted to. She huffed out a sigh and looked down at her feet, kicking her heel into the doorframe. She opened her mouth to say something else, probably meaner, that her still-slightly-drunk brain hadn't come up with yet, but the firefighter cut her off.

"Hey, *Catra*—" they started, and Catra's head snapped up and over to them.

"How the fuck do you know my name?" she shot out before she even had a chance to think the logic through, and then she froze when she saw their face.

"And why the *fuck* do you look like my ex?"

The firefighter—the woman, the golden-haired *goddess* standing next to her in a t-shirt so fitted to her muscles it should have been illegal and the ugliest pants she'd ever seen do such wonders for someone's thighs, with soft, pale skin and a sloped nose and eyes so blue she couldn't believe they were real—blinked down at her in surprise.

"Your ex?" she asked, her head tilting ever so slightly to the side like a confused puppy.

"Yeah," Catra challenged, stepping closer and rising onto her tiptoes to just barely look the woman in the eye. "My *ex*."

Ex was probably *too* strong of a word to describe what that woman had been to her, but it wasn't worth getting into the semantics with a stranger. Besides, she'd disappeared from her life like she'd ghosted her, so if she'd wanted to determine what Catra would call her, she should have stuck around.

The woman faltered, looking extraordinarily lost.

Catra swayed and fell back on her heels, giving the woman a full once-over. "Are you even allowed to work emergency services?"

She frowned, her gorgeous skin wrinkling in dismay. "Why wouldn't I be allowed to work emergency services?"

"Because everyone would constantly call for you to come over , clogging up the phone lines and shit. It just seems impractical."

The woman blinked, pretty auburn lashes meeting for a moment and then parting. "For me to be a firefighter ."

"Yeah," Catra agreed simply .

"Because people would always be calling…"

"Mhm."

"for me to come over ."

"Yup."

"People calling for me to come over?" the woman stage whispered.

"Because you're stupid hot," Catra stage whispered back, losing her resolve in her altered state and letting herself fully leer at the woman. Her form was the exact kind Catra was warm for, tall and broad and beefy. Like a swimmer if they were also a lumberjack, and a handyman, and a casual contestant in weightlifting competitions. So familiar, too, *so* similar to her ex. Even her voice was like hers: warm and strong and confident.

Well, if she couldn't have her ex, maybe she could settle for this woman.

She blinked, blushed profusely, and then scoffed. "Are you hitting on me right now?"

Catra's leer twisted into a glare. "Obviously."

"Because I look like your ex?"

Catra shrugged simply. "You're hot, regardless."

"Must've been a decent relationship," she fished, giving Catra a very strange but attractively attentive look.

"One could've called it a *mirage of bliss.*"

The look on the woman's face intensified sharply, and she frowned. "Very funny, Catra. Now, cut it out."

Now it was Catra's turn to blink. "Cut what out?"

"Stop fucking with me," the woman demanded.

"I'm *not* fucking with you. I'm trying to *fuck* you." Catra shook her head. What part of this was being lost in translation?

The woman stepped closer — *good* — and peered down at Catra's face. "You're pretty drunk, aren't you?"

"Maybe you're not drunk at all," was Catra's answering comeback.

"I'm not," the woman said decisively.

Catra spread her hands wide. "Well, there's your problem!"

"Did you hit your head tonight? Have you fallen at all? Have you taken any drugs?" The woman scrutinized her, and Catra scrutinized her right back.

"What are you, a cop?"

"No," the woman frowned, "but I remember you explicitly asking us *not* to call the cops."

"Yeah. *Fuck* the cops."

"Have you taken any drugs?" the woman repeated patiently.

"No," Catra scowled, "just drank."

The woman frowned, glancing toward her colleagues on the front lawn. "Has anyone checked you out?"

Catra liked the sound of that.

"No, but you can," she offered, raising her eyebrows and sweeping her tail around to tickle the edge of the woman's pants.

The woman looked down at Catra's tail and reached into her pocket, pulling out her phone.

Catra grinned, victory flashing in her mind. "About time you asked for my number."

The last thing she saw was the woman frowning again, her lips beautiful even as they pulled down into a pout, and then the entire world became so bright that she couldn't see a single fucking thing.

"What the *fuck!?*" Catra exclaimed, squeezing her eyes shut and stepping back.

She heard the woman step forward and felt strong, warm fingers wrap around her elbow to steady her. The warmth spread up her arm and settled low in her stomach, buzzing pleasantly.

The world dimmed behind her eyelids, and Catra tentatively peeked one eye open, checking if it was safe. Everything looked normal again, so she opened both eyes, tail lashing behind her.

"What the fuck was that?" she repeated.

The woman ignored her question, letting go of her elbow to hold a finger up in front of her face. "Watch my finger," she ordered, and Catra obediently zeroed in on it.

It was a good finger. Long, appropriately thick, properly agile. The nail was trimmed short, and as the finger started to move back and

forth in front of her, she noticed the knuckle and the rest of the hand looked a little rough, but in a sexy, capable way.

"I can do a lot more with this finger than just watch it," Catra said, eyes snapping from the woman's hand back to her face.

She looked over right in time to watch a new blush blossom across her cheeks, satisfyingly pink and incredibly pretty. Catra watched her with a smirk as she dropped her hand and then her eyes, fumbling with her pants pockets again.

"What's your name?" the woman asked, her voice slightly affected.

"You already know it," Catra answered, brow furrowing gently.

"What's your address?" she prompted again.

Catra's eyebrows fell further into confusion. "We're standing *right* next to my front door."

The woman seemed disappointed when she looked back up at her, her frown back and the blush mostly dissipated. "Can I see your arm?"

"Only if you promise to do something worthwhile with it," Catra said, raising one arm from her side.

The woman took it and started maneuvering something around it, and it took Catra a moment to realize it was a blood pressure cuff like they had at the doctor's office. The woman put it on her carefully, then donned a stethoscope, just like a doctor, and touched the end to Catra's arm. They were both surprisingly warm against her from being in the other woman's pockets, and Catra watched with fascination as the woman checked her blood pressure.

She nodded as she let the air out and took the stethoscope out of her ears, and Catra tilted her head, her tail reaching out for the woman's leg again.

"Do you need to check my heart, too?" she asked, reaching up for the collar of her cropped shirt and pulling it down to expose the top of her chest.

The woman's gaze flickered up from her equipment and anchored there, taking in the angle of her collarbone, the silk of her chest fur, and the slight rise of the top of her breast. Catra felt it burn into her, watched the intensity in the woman's eyes as they memorized her skin, and then slowly dragged up to meet hers and felt something shift as they did.

Suddenly, it felt like Catra was the one missing something about this conversation.

"No," the woman finally answered, voice quiet and hoarse. "But I need to touch you again."

Catra let her shirt collar go and flicked her tail up to the woman's hip, dancing up her side. "All yours," she said, but the words she meant to come out as a challenge came out like an offer instead.

Or a promise.

The woman swallowed visibly and stepped closer, face growing serious as she reached out and slid a hand into Catra's hair.

Catra's eyes fell shut immediately, all her brainpower shifting into appreciating how well this woman's hand wrapped around the back of her neck, settling warmly at the base of her skull for a moment. Then it began to move, massaging into the skin along her spine, and Catra was much too far gone to stop the soft noise that rose from the stirring warmth in her gut and found its way out of her mouth.

The woman's hand stuttered but then continued, going down to the tops of her shoulders and then heading back up. It traced along the side of her throat, raising to slip along her jaw, and Catra's head moved into it immediately. She nuzzled her cheek into the woman's

palm, a deep purr rumbling inside her chest, and her hand stopped moving to hold her.

t held her for so long, in fact, unmoving and still as a statue, that Catra's purr eventually died out, and she peeked one eye open to see what was going on.

The firefighter was simply staring at her, cheeks flushed a deeper pink than before, and eyes filled with something Catra recognized but was far too inebriated to name.

The second their eyes made contact, the woman ripped her hand back, leaving Catra to stumble slightly as she tried to carry the weight of her own head again. She blinked as she steadied herself and watched the woman dig clumsily through her pockets, her new blush spreading down her neck and disappearing under the collar of her t-shirt.

"Uh," she started, her voice wobbling, "I uh." She cleared her throat as she finally found what she'd been looking for. "I need your finger."

"You can have more than one after that," Catra couldn't stop herself from offering, holding her hand out and raising her middle and ring fingers up together suggestively.

The woman reached for her hand, and then sharp pain exploded in her middle finger.

"OW" Catra shouted, trying to yank her hand back and discovering the woman was holding it in a death grip. She fumbled with something and then touched it to her finger, less painfully, and then finally released her.

Catra pulled back and glared viciously at the woman. She stared resolutely down at her device and pretended Catra didn't even exist, leaving her to cradle her hand to her chest and assess the damage alone. Only one finger was bleeding, right on the tip, so Catra put it into her mouth and sucked it off.

She watched the woman nod at her device and pull something papery from the depths of her stupid pockets, and only then did she finally look up again and acknowledge Catra.

Her blush was still bright, and somehow, it deepened even further when their eyes met, turning her to the color of a ripe summer tomato and the temperature of a sweltering summer day. Catra grinned, unable to help herself, and hollowed her cheeks as she dragged her finger from her mouth and reached for the woman with it.

Her goal was to touch her chest and then trace as far down as she could get away with, but she never managed to get there.

At the last possible moment, the woman dodged her touch, leaning back and then grabbing her finger. Before she could react, something was stuck onto it, and then it was suddenly returned to her. Catra held it up and looked at it —wrapped around the bleeding tip was a band-aid, perfectly applied.

She blinked, and before she could speak, the woman did.

"Your vitals are all good, and nothing hurt when I touched it, so I think you're fine."…

"No, *you're* fine," Catra purred.

"Just *very* drunk," the woman finished.

"*You're* not drunk enough," Catra corrected her again, crossing her arms.

"Look," the woman sighed, shifting her weight and holding out her hands to gesture. "I just came over here to see how you were doing. I'm sure this was really scary."

Fine. Catra looked down as she remembered why this beautiful woman was on her lawn to begin with, and her crossed arms turned

to hug her sides. "I wasn't *scary*," she denied.

"Catra," the woman said, softer. A large, warm hand landed on her shoulder, and her head tilted with concern. "You don't have to do that with me. You can say that you were scared. I was scared when we got here."

Catra frowned, wondering why the woman's face was blurring, and her cheeks felt wet. "I wasn't *scared*," she bit, except instead of a snarky comeback, it sounded like a blubbering baby.

Suddenly, her face was being tucked into a warm, dry shoulder, and her body was being crushed against another's. She immediately folded into the feeling, clinging to the woman like a life raft. Catra didn't realize how scared she had been for Perfuma and herself until she was offered this embrace of security; a strong, stable body to lean into and collapse against.

It was a strange thing, showing so much vulnerability to a stranger, but it didn't feel vulnerable. There was so much familiarity to her, to the way she looked and sounded and smelled and to the way that she held her.

The woman held her like she could save her. She held her like she could keep her safe, like she *wanted* to keep her safe, like she didn't want to let her go.

It was doing something to Catra's heart, something she was far too drunk to process, but something she knew would haunt her once she was sober.

Altogether, it was *far* too religious of an experience to be having with a hot stranger on her front lawn at 3 o'clock in the morning.

The woman held her until her whole shoulder was soaked with Catra's tears, and they both heard her Captain calling her back to the truck.

"I have to go," she started, her words twisting with an apology. "But it's okay, your friend is okay. She's going to be just fine and probably very hungover tomorrow."

Catra swiped at the drying tears on her face and looked over to see Perfuma sitting against the house a few yards away, smiling dazedly up at the sky and nursing a water bottle with cloudy liquid inside.

"What about my door?" Catra's voice wobbled as she forced the words to come out, coating her question with petulance.

The woman chuckled lightly, waving towards her Captain to indicate she would join them in a second and then shrugging. "There are lots of people out there that can fix doors. You could probably do it yourself with YouTube and a lot of determination. If you get really desperate, the fire station's not too far away."

Catra looked up at the woman with scrutiny, trying to tell if she was making fun of her, but her face was open and honest.

"Stay safe, Catra," she wished, starting to walk backward. "And drink some water before bed."

"Yeah, whatever," Catra scowled, her cheeks heating unnecessarily as she stared the woman down, daring her to walk away.

She did, cracking one last half-smile and shaking her head as she turned on her heel. Jogging the rest of the way back to the fire truck, she joined her coworkers as they piled on and pulled away from the scene.

Catra watched them go, stepping over and sitting down next to Perfuma.

"How are you holding up?" she asked.

"Amazing," Perfuma breathed, not taking her eyes off the stars. "The heavens sent me a sign."

Catra sighed, leaning back against the house and looking up, too. "What sign is that?"

"Love is real," she breathed. "You just have to be patient."

Catra looked down at her, blinking. Her entire meltdown after this most recent break-up was that love wasn't real, just a treacherous lie, and she would never ever be happy again. Such a sudden change in her mood was more than just a touch alarming.

Right, Catra agreed with doubt. "I think we should go inside."

"If that's what you'd like," Perfuma nodded, staying unmoving. "You'll know what I mean soon enough."

Catra stifled a groan – Perfuma was moving into the cryptic fortune-teller stage of her inebriation, which was always the worst one. "Okay, come on, it's time for bed."

Perfuma hummed, letting Catra pull her up and escort her back inside. They made it all the way to the guest room she'd be staying in before Perfuma turned on her, leaning close and whispering, "Love will find you, too. Love will find us all."

Before Catra could answer, Perfuma twirled into the room and shut the door with a shocking amount of confidence, considering she'd just been locked in a completely different room of the house while under the influence.

Catra blinked at the door in her face and grumbled.

"Love could find her ass when she was sober."

Catra woke with a groan and a heavy nagging in the back of her brain. Her head felt rattled, and as she tried to put the pieces together as to where she was and why everything felt so horrible, parts of the night before started to filter into her brain.

She'd thrown a partyfor Perfuma. For Perfuma's break-up. To try and get her mind off her horrible ex-girlfriend and back onto her friends and the happy parts of her life. They'd had a good turnout, most of the people they invited showing up, and for a while, it had worked. Perfuma had felt better.

And then someone's stupid fucking ringtone had gone off, and of course, it was the same stupid ringtone Perfuma's ex had used, and it set her off immediately.

Things had rapidly devolved from there.

Catra dragged herself into a sitting position, cradling her head in her hands and wincing as her brain adjusted to the new angle of gravity. She'd *definitely* had too much to drink last night, trying to keep up with Perfuma so she wouldn't be alone in how drunk she was.

Until she stepped back inside from a sneaky backyard smoke and was completely crossfaded, and Catra had abruptly cut herself off from everything to try and run damage control.

Which had ended with Perfuma locking herself in the bathroom.

The bathroom.

The door.

Fuck

Catra dug her fingers into her hair and tugged with frustration as she remembered she no longer had a bathroom door.

Well, she *had* it. They'd left it here. The door was just sitting out in the hall *beside* the bathroom now, instead of straight up on its hinges where it belonged.

The flashing lights and sirens of the fire truck filled her memory, the sight of half a dozen firefighters jumping off the truck and rushing

into her house, not one she was going be forgetting any time soon, for better or for worse.

Everything after they came inside was a blur, but it felt more lost to adrenaline and panic than to her drunken state. But she remembered that they got Perfuma out, and she was still conscious, just *very* fucked up, so they took her outside for some air. She remembered watching Perfuma sitting with them on the lawn, trying to come down from the excitement and process that everything was okay. And then —

Catra's brain stopped, halting on the fuzzy memory of one of the firefighters coming over to check on her. Her voice filtered into her ears and her face conjured in her mind, and Catra felt her heart jump inside her chest.

Adora?

Catra forced her brain to restart, replaying the memory of their conversation and how she'd looked and sounded and trying desperately to analyze the blurry edges with her sober brain. She remembered thinking at the time that the woman looked like Adora, but now that she had a degree of separation from it, she remembered how strangely she'd acted when she called her her ex, and then again when she'd called their relationship a marriage of bliss. She remembered the cute way she had tilted her head, how she knew her name even though she hadn't announced it to anyone except the 911 receptionist, how flustered she'd been when Catra pulled the neck of her shirt down, and…

And the way she'd hugged her , the way she'd let Catra cry into her shoulder. The way she'd told her to stay safe before walking away .

Holy fuck.

That *was* Adora.

Since when was Adora a fucking firefighter!? Since when was she in Bright Moon!? W as Catra supposed to believe that they'd been living in the same town for who knows how long now, and she never knew!?

Catra ripped her blankets off her lap and leaped from the bed, storming out of her room and down the hall. The guest bedroom's door was open, so she strode right past that and the doorless bathroom and made for the kitchen.

She found Perfuma exactly where she expected to: sitting at the table nursing a giant mug of tea and a small bowl of cereal. She looked even more miserable than Catra had felt when she woke up this morning, so she forced herself to slow down and check in before she moved on to the important business she had come for.

"Hey , how are you feeling?" she asked q uietly , pausing beside one of the chairs on the opposite side of the table.

Perfuma met her eyes with a dead look, the usual vibrance in her expression gone. "I would like to *never* repeat the events of last night," she uttered q uietly .

Catra nodded. "Agreed. Do you need anything?"

"I hate to be a bother." P erfuma started, and Catra shot her a disapproving look. She caught it and offered a half-smile. "Fine, do you have any aspirin? I tried looking for it, but I gave up before I could find any."

"Of course," Catra nodded, turning on her heel before Perfuma had even finished her sentence to go and retrieve the medicine. When she returned with it, and a cup of cool water, Perfuma took them gratefully.

"Y ou're too kind," she praised, and Catra snorted ungracefully .

"Hey , look," Catra started, quietly pulling a chair out and sitting down. "Do you remember the firefighters that were here last night?"

Perfuma blinked with a touch of confusion, and then the memory seemed to dawn on her, and something that could only be described as pure bliss spread over her face. *"Y es,"* she answered dreamily.

"Y eah, they were hot," Catra agreed quickly . "Do you remember the blonde one?"

The look in Perfuma's eyes doubled, and she propped an elbow on the table to rest her cheek in her hand. "Of course I do. She saved my life."

Catra's eyes narrowed slightly, and she tried to push down the sudden and unfitting spark of jealously that flared up at the words. "Y eah, Adora," she said.

Perfuma frowned gently. "I don't think I'd use the word adorable to describe her. Something stronger, like beautiful or powerful or *sexy* ."

Catra felt her tail whip against the back of her chair. "No, her name. It' s Adora."

Perfuma's frown doubled, and she dropped her hand down to the table as she straightened. "No, it' s Scorpia."

Catra blinked. Who the fuck was Scorpia? "No, it' s Adora. Just under six foot, long golden ponytail with the *stupidest* poof, blue eyes, so buff she shouldn't be allowed outside?"

"I think we're thinking of dif ferent beautiful and buff firefighters, Catra," Perfuma said softly , the displeasure in her expression easing. "Mine was bleach-blonde, hair cropped on the sides and flipping over on the top. Strong, comforting arms and gorgeous maroon pincers."

D Catra vaguely remembered that one of the firefighters talking to Perfuma on the lawn had been a Scorpioni, and the pieces finally fit together.

"Y eah, we're definitely talking about dif ferent people." Catra opened her mouth to ask about Adora and then paused. "W ait ~~is~~ this why you were talking about love before bed last night? Cause one of them came and swept you off your feet, *lit-erally* "?

"She' s not just *one-of-them*," Perfuma said, only slightly annoyed. "Scorpia' s my *soul-mate.* "

"Didn't you *just* meet her last night?"

"When you know , you know," she sighed happily .

Catra used every ounce of her willpower to restrain a groan. That was the exact same phrase Perfuma had used every single *other* time she'd met someone she intended to date, and all of those had ended similarly to last night's events.

"h a big fucking *disaster* .

"f you say so," was the nicest reply Catra could muster before continuing. "Do you remember seeing Adora, though? It would be nice to get confirmation that she wasn't losing her mind and simply imagining that she had been there comforting her last night.

"Hmmm I don't know ," Perfuma shrugged, "you said she was tall, with a ponytail?"

"Y eah ," Catra cut of f, spying a pen on the table and grabbing the nearest napkin. She scrawled a sketch of Adora's most prominent features, highlighting what would make her recogniz-able and forgoing the rest of the details. She turned it upside down and slid it towards Perfuma, who leaned down to look at it quiz-zically .

It was only a stick figure, but Catra couldn't deny she'd done well to get as much of Adora's likeness as one could get onto a couple simple lines.

"Do you remember her?"

Perfuma's face wrinkled in thought. "I think I might, yeah. She didn't help me on the lawn, but I think I remember her in the bathroom. I think she helped take the door down so my true love could get through to me."

Catra nodded, a small wave of relief washing over her. "Okay , great." She didn't imagine Adora.

So, the next question was, why was she here? What kind of joke was the universe playing to make her show up last night? Why hadn't she said anything about moving into town?

Why hadn't she said anything about *them* last night?

Catra supposed that maybe it could be because Catra hadn't seemed to remember her. Well, she'd *remembered* her just fine. She just hadn't realized that the person she remembered and the person that was in front of her were one and the same. She could see how maybe, she guessed, that could have made Adora feel a little awkward about saying something.

But she'd *known* Catra! And she'd listened to Catra hit on her and call her her ex! They'd been *married* for Christ's sake — where the hell did Adora get off on showing up to save her friend and wreck her house and then just *leaving*? Without even exchanging numbers or anything!

Catra stood abruptly, picking up her drawing of Adora and looking down at Perfuma. "I'm gonna get dressed and go to the fire station to find Adora. Do you need anything? Do you want to come? I can find your soulmate too while I'm at it, if you need."

Perfuma brightened, a lovely smile spreading over her face. "I already have Scorpia's number, and we have a date set up for Wednesday, but that's very sweet. I'm glad you're going to find your soulmate. I told you love would find you."

Catra wanted to snap back at her, but instead of anger, embarrassment bloomed on her cheeks. "Yeah, whatever. Just lock the front door when you head home."

"Of course," Perfuma agreed, and Catra spun on her heel to go get dressed.

The fire station was just around the corner from their house, which was the point of a fire station, but the expediency with which Catra was able to pull into the station's parking lot only made her anger rise. Adora had been this close this whole time, and they'd never run into each other? The horrible thought that maybe Adora had been avoiding her crossed her mind, and the only thing that kept it from digging its self-hating roots into her brain was the memory of Adora's warm arms wrapping around her body last night, crushing her into her chest. People didn't hug people they were avoiding like that.

Adora didn't hug people she was avoiding like that.

A timid, hopeful voice in the depths of her mind whispered a question – what kind of people *did* Adora hug like that? What category did Catra actually fall into?

Swallowing with an unexpected amount of newfound nervousness, Catra parked in a spot off to the side, grabbed her napkin, and got out of the car. Setting her shoulders, she forced herself to stride into the open garage and look for signs of life.

"Hello?" she called out, perhaps a bit too demanding. No one answered her, so she walked around one of the parked trucks, calling out again. "*Heelloooo?*"

She cut off as she spied a door to the inside of the building —she'd ignored the clear visitor's entrance on the outside because the garage had been open, implying someone was inside, but maybe she did need to go inside. She was wrapping her hand around the handle when her ears finally caught footsteps sounding behind her.

"Hey!" a rough voice called out. "Can I help you?"

Catra spun to find a gigantic, pink-skinned woman approaching her, wearing a casual firefighter's uniform and raising a white eyebrow.

"Hey ," Catra answered, straightening up a little. "I'm looking for someone who works here, Adora. Is she here right now?"

The woman raised both her eyebrows and set her hands on her hips. "Adora?" she asked, her tone impossible to read.

"Y eah. Adora," Catra repeated, setting her voice harder . "She' s just under six foot. She looks like —uh," she hesitated, looking down at her napkin with a flash of embarrassment and then deciding to double down. "She looks like this," she declared, bravely holding the napkin out to the woman.

She took it, staring down at it with a confusing scrutiny. Her lips wobbled, as if they couldn't decide what to do, and then a shocking grin split down her face.

"Did you draw this?" she asked.

Catra bristled, narrowing her eyes. "Y es."

"Hold on a second."

Before Catra could stop her, the woman moved forward, blowing right past her to swing the door to the building-wide. "*Y o, Scorpiokull!*" she shouted just before the door swung shut behind her. "Y ou *gotta* see this!"

Catra frowned, staring at the closed office door and listening to the soft chatter now coming from inside. The door was fireproof (obviously), so it blocked most of the sound, but she could just make out the woman's voice and another conversing with amusement.

It didn't sound like Adora, she didn't think, but it also didn't sound unlike her.

Suddenly the chatter got much closer, and Catra barely had time to step backward before the door swung open in front of her.

The woman from before emerged again, and another woman followed her – tall, mocha-skinned, and smiling, with side shaves and a long, dark braid that fell down her back.

The new woman smiled at her, something mischievous in the turn of her lips as she sized Catra up, and then she spoke. "You drew this?" she asked, holding the napkin up.

Catra was right – she *didn't* sound unlike Adora, even though she definitely wasn't her.

Catra pushed her shoulders down and back, not liking whatever was going on here. "Yes," she declared. "Is Adora here or not?"

"No," the first woman laughed.

"Well, does she work here?!" Catra exclaimed.

"Yes," the second woman answered, kinder but still amused. "She volunteers on the night shift. She's not full-time yet."

"Well, do you know where I could find her right now?" Catra bit out.

"What's your name?"

Catra glared. Maybe this was a lost cause. Maybe Perfuma could text her soulmate and see if she knew how to find Adora. "Does it matter?" she answered.

The woman hardened, glaring back at her. *W sqaer?*

Catra stared her down, wondering if she should just leave while she was ahead. But something in the woman's face, something in her familiar voice, forced her to answer. "Catra."

She grinned wide. "That's what I thought."

"What the fuck is that supposed to mean?" Catra growled.

The woman ignored her and pointed out of the garage, across the street. "My sister's at the gym, down that road a bit, and then you hang a left."

The woman's words stopped Catra in her tracks, and she blinked. "*You're* Adora's sister?"

She remembered hearing about her, remembered the way Adora couldn't shut up about her. Mara? Was that her name? Adora had been so proud when she'd talked about her.

Mara nodded. "Yeah."

Catra felt heat flood her cheeks as she reconciled that not only had she just been incredibly rude to Adora's favorite person on the planet, but also that Mara had known who she was.

Adora had told Mara about her.

She wondered what she'd said.

"Thank you," Catra forced herself to say.

Mara smiled easily. "Sure thing."

The other woman looked mildly confused as Catra spun and headed out of the garage, and Catra heard them speak quietly as she hurried to her car.

Well what was that? the first woman asked.

Adora's ex-wife," Mara replied, her tone playful and teasing.

Catra yanked open her car door and got inside, knuckles wrapping tightly around the steering wheel.

Like *hell* was she her ex-wife, not now that she'd found her again.

Not if she had anything to say about it.

Catra found the gym with no problem — she'd never been to it herself, but she'd driven past it at least a million times. She parked, swearing that Adora better have only just moved here or she was going to be in even more trouble than she already was, and strode into the building with her curls flying.

She didn't even bother looking at the front desk attendant, eyes already combing the gym for a familiar face, and she would have blown right past the desk entirely if a familiar, squeaky voice hadn't stopped her.

"Catra?"

Catra turned with a flourish, finding Bonnie's annoying boyfriend, Kyle, standing behind the counter and looking at her with the same confusion that she was looking at him with.

"Are you here to use the gym?" he asked, and Catra immediately bristled at his shocked tone.

"Maybe I am," she shot back.

"Oh. Well, you'll have to fill out the trial paperwork"—

Catra barely restrained her eye roll. "I'm not here to use the gym," she snapped, turning back to the large room beyond them. "I'm just

looking for someone."

"Oh," Kyle repeated, laughing nervously. "Well, I can't let you enter the gym unless you're a member or here on a trial"—

"What, like you're gonna stop me?" Catra laughed, still scouring the floor for a blonde ponytail. "I could snap you in half with my tail, Kyle."

Kyle made an indignant noise, high and affronted, and launched into a rambling defense that Catra didn't hear a single word of.

Her eyes had finally found her target—Adora's unmistakable hairdo standing tall beside the pull-up bar.

She wasn't alone, and Catra barely had time to appreciate Adora's outfit (barely anything at all, a heavy-duty red sports bra and a pair of what might have been considered shorts on someone else, but on her could only be described as sin-filled pieces of cloth) and how much muscle it showed (so much muscle it was going to haunt both Catra's dreams and nightmares for years, thick rippling muscles that tensed and elongated and pushed power through her body as she moved, golden bulging muscles that Catra wanted to feel under her body and hands and claws, hot and sweaty and ready for her) before she was forced to confront that Adora's strong, handsome hands were wrapped around another woman's waist.

The woman was working on her pull-ups, struggling to safely keep control over her muscles as she reached the top of the bar and then tried to head back down, and Adora was supporting her from the waist and speaking gently to her. Catra didn't need to be close to them to know exactly how Adora was holding her—loose enough to let her do it herself, but firm enough to let her know she'd catch her on the way down.

To let her know she wouldn't let her slip right through her fingers.

The fragile sanity Catra had been holding onto since waking up sober suddenly snapped, and she shouted across the gym.

"Hey, asshole!"

Her words were loud enough for Adora to squeak in surprise and for several patrons to pause their exercises and look up, but Adora and her woman didn't hear her, lost in their own little world.

Forgetting Adora entirely, Catra marched towards them, crossing the gym as fast as she could go without running, lest she look desperate.

"Hey!" she screamed again.

Adora and the woman both jumped, stopping mid-rep and turning to find Catra bearing down on them. Recognition flashed in Adora's eyes while confusion filled the other woman's, and Adora turned back to help her down to the floor.

Catra arrived at the same moment Adora finally took her hands back, turning to face Catra wholly and blink down at her.

On the way up to her face, Catra was forced to discover the fact that Adora's fire-engine red sports bra wasn't *just* heavy-duty but was one of the ones that zipped up the front. Zipped down the front? Opened from the front.

Whatever.

She let this news wash over her and turn into more fuel for the fire, stepping into Adora's space and growling, "What the *fuck* is wrong with you?!"

Adora's eyebrows knitted together as her eyes traced all over Catra's face and body, taking in her sharp anger and fists, and then turning to check behind her, as if there was someone else Catra might be yelling at.

"I'm talking to *you*, dumbass," Catra spit, jabbing a claw into Adora's shoulder. It was annoyingly hard and warm. "I said what the fuck is wrong with you, Adora?"

"Uhhh." Adora started, casting a glance to the woman still standing beside her and then to the rest of the gym and its patrons behind Catra. "What the fuck is wrong with *you*?!" she hissed, her voice quiet but angry.

"What's wrong with *me*?!" Catra answered, her voice just as loud as before.

"What's going on?" the woman beside Adora asked, looking between the two of them.

"Can it, Pigtails," Catra spared the woman a glare, "this is between me and this *meathead*."

Adora's expression grew darker, her cheeks flushing lightly and her jaw set hard. "What the *fuck* are you doing?!" she demanded, her voice filled with a fury that Catra had never heard before. It was deep enough that her stomach flipped, and a tiny, annoying voice that sounded a lot like her conscience piped up from the back of her mind.

Maybe she was taking this a little *too* far.

"Who *are* you?!" the woman jumped in again, still trying to piece together what the hell was happening and how she'd ended up in the middle of it.

Her righteous tone took Catra's tiny conscience and threw it right out the window, and she spun on her ferociously.

"I'm her *wife*," Catra declared, her eyes involuntarily flickering to Adora and back again as the word came out. "Who the hell are you?!"

Adora's reaction to the word *wife* was intense and unmistakable, cycling through several different emotions.

First, her eyebrows skyrocketed, reaching for her hairline and filling her face with surprise. It quickly softened, something much more intimate and familiar seeping in. Then it faded entirely for something more charged, a heat filling her eyes and setting her jaw.

It was clear that the four-letter word still stirred something inside of her, just like it had that night. The night that they were married.

Well.

They weren't *actually* married—legally, in the eyes of the Etherian law, they never had been.

But what did legalese really matter, anyway? What was marriage more than an agreement, a unity two people agreed to make? They'd done that, Adora dropping to one knee to propose and Catra accepting, and then dragging her back up off the ground to meet her in a kiss and make it official.

And sure, maybe it had mostly been a joke. Maybe it had been born from disingenuous, playful intentions, but neither of them ever denied that it had quickly spiraled into something much deeper.

Two years ago, Bonnie dragged Catra to a party out in the suburbs of the Whispering Woods, some friend of a friend's party where someone she was trying to hook up with was going for the night. She'd eventually lost Catra in the basement, and by a stroke of luck or fate or by a cosmic joke, the stranger she'd been standing next to when someone tried to round up people to play the Newlywed game had been Adora.

It was a game for couples, where someone asked each pair a personal question about one of them, and they both answered, one answering honestly and the other trying to guess what their partner would say. It was a game for people who knew each other well, not

complete strangers, but they were offering a prize, and Adora was hot, so when they approached them and asked if they wanted to play, Catra said yes.

She wasn't expecting anything other than a bit of fun messing with a hot stranger and a small chance at some cash, but she'd been trying a new practice of keeping her expectations low, and it seemed to be working.

Because they'd fucking won.

Was their chemistry weirdly amazing and intense for two strangers?

Yes.

Did they bicker like they'd been married for twenty years when they disagreed about an answer?

Yes.

Was everyone else so drunk that they didn't notice that they were blatantly cheating?

Maybe also yes.

But they'd done it.

And then they'd spent the rest of the party doing what a newlywed couple should do—getting drunk, celebrating their life together, and making out on every surface they could find.

It was the best not-date Catra had ever fucking had. She'd thought it had been for Adora too (that's what she'd said at the time, at least), but when the night finally ended and Bonnie resurfaced, Catra gave Adora her number and left, and that had been the last she'd heard from her. Adora never called, never texted, never DM'd her and left a prank voicemail. She'd dropped off the face of the planet, and just like that, Catra was single once again.

Until she'd showed up at her house in the middle of the night as a fucking *firefighter* and saved her best friend and not said a single fucking thing about their not-relationship.

But whatever. This woman didn't need to know all of that.

"Wife" would suffice.

"I'm her *client*," the woman responded. "Adora, what the hell?"

Her *client*?

Something in the pit of Catra's stomach dropped viciously as her brain caught up to her heart, and she abruptly realized she'd gotten something very wrong here.

"Uhhh," Adora started, her voice no longer angry and instead a bit strangled as she turned to her client. "I think we need to call it a day, Starla. I'm so sorry about this. I won't charge you for this session, don't worry."

Catra's mouth opened, and Adora immediately cut her a look, making her snap her mouth shut without saying a word.

Which was just as well, really—guilt and fear were starting to roil in her gut, and it was making it very hard to find anything to say that she thought she'd actually be able to voice.

With a huff and a glare at Catra, Starla grabbed her water bottle from the ground and stalked off.

Adora moved as well, and for a moment, Catra thought she was going to follow her, watching as she snatched up a shirt and a water bottle from the ground. But then she turned back, shifting everything into one hand so she could grab Catra's with her other, and she stalked off toward the back of the gym.

Catra resisted at first, trying to pull her hand from Adora's and show some indignation at being treated like a child, but then Adora tugged

her closer and weaved their fingers together, and Catra couldn't find it in her to pull away from that.

Adora pulled her into a room marked "Employees Only" and locked the door behind them, finally releasing Catra in what looked like a small and surprisingly clean locker room.

"What are you doing here, Catra?" Adora asked, looking down at her with a stupidly attractive stern curiosity.

"Do you work here?" Catra asked, casting her gaze back to the door they'd just entered and feeling fear and dread gather in her chest.

"Yes?" Adora answered, incredulous.

Catra's fear fell heavily onto her, making her wish she was much smaller than she actually was. "Oh," she mumbled. "Oh, *fuck*. Your sister didn't say you were working. I just thought"…

Adora blinked. "You talked to Mara?"

"Yeah," Catra swallowed, "I went to the station first."

"Oh. She sent you here?"

"Yeah."

"But she didn't tell you that I worked here wait, what did you think I was doing?"

Catra set her jaw, crossing her arms over her chest and watching Adora watch her. "I don't want to answer that."

"What did you think I was doing?" Adora pressed, stepping closer to her and forcing Catra to look up to avoid staring at her chest.

She didn't know if it was meant as an intimidation or a seduction tactic, but unfortunately, it was working double time. She could feel

the heat radiating off Adora's skin, and it was taking too much of her resolve not to look down to keep her answer to herself.

"*Oh*, I thought you were flirting with her," Catra finally broke. "I didn't realize you were working."

Adora laughed, the only thing that might possibly make this situation even more embarrassing. "You thought I was flirting?"

"You had your hands all over her," Catra exclaimed, fighting the blush that was darkening her cheeks.

"I was *spotting* her," Adora defended, still chuckling. "You should know what it looks like when I'm flirting with someone."

Catra felt a burst of embarrassment and arousal shoot through her in the most irritating way that only Adora could cause. "*Whatever*, I get it now. I'm sorry," she growled, eyes flickering around anything that wasn't Adora's face.

Adora moved forward, growing closer and closer until Catra was forced to look up at her and step back so they wouldn't collide. Adora advanced again, her face oddly serious, and Catra stepped back again, her back suddenly hitting the wall.

"You were mad because you thought I was flirting with her?" Adora asked, something familiar but unidentifiable in her voice, and as she asked the words, she set a hand against the wall beside Catra's head.

Catra's eyes slid along the curves of her arm, taking in the bare skin and hot heat and hard muscles that Adora was *definitely* flexing to show off as she looked at them, and narrowed her eyes in disbelief. Adora was going to get mad at Catra for breaking into her workplace and publicly staking her claim over her, but she was perfectly content to drag her into the employee's locker room and put the moves on her after not calling or saying anything last night? She needed to make up her damn mind about what she wanted.

And she needed to stop being so hot that she got away with her indecision.

Catra's eyes finally snapped up to her face, her chin raising stubbornly. "Yeah. I was," she admitted with the hardest voice she could manage.

"Why?" Adora asked, leaning down so slowly Catra wasn't even sure she realized she was doing it.

Catra slit her eyes into a glare, resisting the growing urge to grab her ex-wife's face and drag her down to meet her lips. She knew how it would end if they started that, and she was still too angry to let that happen.

Adora's expression gentled, and her voice was soft when it came out. "Tell me."

It stirred Catra's heart, and that decided it. Whatever answer Adora was hoping for, what she would get was the truth.

"Because you were at my fucking *house* last night," she spat, starting with much more venom than Adora was expecting. She leaned away instinctively, giving Catra some space, and Catra filled it with her rage. "Because you *saved* Perfuma! And you fucking talked to me and touched me and hugged me, and you didn't even fucking say *anything*! What the fuck didn't you say anything?! And you never fucking called. What the fuck is that about?! Because I *know* you liked me! We were fucking perfect together. What the fuck happened!? Do you have another wife somewhere that I don't know about?"

Adora's eyebrows were so high they were reaching for the heavens, bewilderment painting her face. It took a few moments of silence for her to realize that it was her turn to answer, and when she did, she sounded hurt.

"You didn't remember me, Catra. What was I supposed to say?"

"I don't know! Anything!? There were *so* many things you could have said, but you just—" Catra cut off, her voice sharply breaking.

Adora leaned back in, face twisting with concern. "What?"

Catra looked down, gaze boring into the floor between their feet as she summoned the courage to finish her sentence.

"You were just going to let me go. Again. Just like that."

Adora's arm dropped from beside her head, and the movement drew her gaze back up to find Adora, serious, staring at her with what could only be described as disappointment.

"I wasn't going to let you *go*! I just—" Adora broke off and swallowed, and Catra realized with a crushing feeling that she wasn't the one Adora was disappointed in.

She was disappointed in herself.

"I didn't know what to *say*. I was so scared when we pulled up, and I saw it was your house, and then I was so relieved when I realized you were okay, but then when we talked, you didn't even know it was me. I was going to take a few days and try to figure it out. I'll try to figure out if you'd even *want* to know that it was really me."

Catra caught the large hand Adora had dropped to her side and wove their fingers together, squeezing with the same tightness she felt in her chest. "Why wouldn't I want to know that?"

"You called me your *ex*," Adora said, and the hurt that had caused her was plain to see.

Catra gripped Adora's hand tighter—as tight as she could—and argued, "I also said we had a marriage of bliss!"

"Catra," Adora started, her voice sad even as her hand began to squeeze Catra's back. "We were married for, like, *four hours*. Not legally."

Catra frowned viciously. "You proposed to me with a corn puff shaped like an onion ring, Adora. That's *legally binding.*"

A laugh like the sun slipped out of Adora's lips, breaking her wounded composure and filling the small room with echoing hope.

Catra was hopeless but to join her, laughing at her own joke and the ridiculous scenario they'd met in and the even more ridiculous situation they'd landed themselves in now.

"Fuck," Catra chuckled, easing up on her death grip on Adora's hand but not letting go entirely. "I'm sorry for all of this. I was just really hurt that you never called me. And then when I woke up this morning and realized the hot stranger I met last night that looked just like you *was* actually you I... might've lost it a little bit."

"It's okay," Adora smiled, stroking a warm thumb over Catra's wrist. "I don't know how you expected me to call when you never gave me your number, but I understand. I just moved in with my sister a few months ago, and I wasn't sure if you were still living around here, but I really hoped that you were. I never dreamed that I'd report to a call in the middle of that night and end up at your house."

"What the fuck do you mean?" Catra scowled. "I gave you my number on a napkin before I left."

"No," Adora corrected with a wince, "you *wrote* your number on a napkin. You never actually handed it to me."

"Yes, I did," Catra insisted, blinking dumbly.

"No, you didn't. You were about to, and then your friend came by to get you to leave and almost fell on us, and by the time I helped you get her outside to go home, the napkin was totally lost. I didn't even realize until you guys had gotten in the cab and left, but I never got it."

Catra blinked, remembering how trashed Bonnie had been when she found them. How much help she'd needed to get into the cab, and then how Bonnie had gotten sick, and Catra had found a random napkin in her pocket to give to her…

"Oh, *fuck,*" she muttered. "I'm an even bigger asshole than I thought I was."

Adora chuckled good-naturedly, raising her free hand to lean against the wall next to Catra again. "It's okay," she said.

"No, it's not," Catra insisted, voice painted with regret. Why hadn't she fucking handed that napkin over and saved them both all this trouble?!

"Yes, it is," Adora argued back, squeezing her hand and shifting closer. "If you weren't a total asshole, then we wouldn't have met again last night, and you never would have stormed into my workplace and screamed at one of my clients."

"Why are you saying that like it was a *good* thing?" Catra bit out, embarrassment flooding through her again.

"Because it *is* – well, let me be clear, *please* never do that again. I think Starla will understand, but I really can't afford to lose any clients right now, and they might fire me entirely if this is a recurring thing. But now that I know why it happened, I'm not gonna lie and say that it wasn't *super* hot."

Catra snorted, gaze skipping down to see how close Adora had gotten and then trading her embarrassment for smugness. "Really?"

"Yeah," Adora shrugged casually, tongue darting out to wet her bottom lip. "You storming in here all angry, calling yourself my wife to fend off another woman"…

Catra offered her a Cheshire grin, raising an eyebrow and snaking her tail up the side of Adora's calf. "Good to know you like the

jealous types,"she purred.

"I like *you,* "Adora corrected, crowding her so tightly against the wall that their knees knocked. "This isn't really how I imagined our reunion going, but I really miss being married to you."

"Yeah, I know you do,"Catra said, just to be a little shit. She grinned up at Adora, and Adora grinned back as she continued. "Do you wanna get remarried?"

Adora stared down at her, hope growing in her eyes. "Does that mean "—

"I'm asking you on a date, Adora,"Catra clarified.

"Yes, *yes,* absolutely, yeah,"Adora rushed out, breath washing over Catra's face.

Catra wrapped her tail around Adora's knee, leaning up enough to bump their noses together and then pulling back. "Maybe if it goes well, you can fix my door after,"she offered.

Adora blinked, the softest blush rising in her cheeks as she searched Catra's face. "Is, uh, is that a euphemism, or?"..

"No,"Catra laughed, "I *literally* need you to fix my door."

Adora joined her in laughing, nodding good-naturedly. "Got it, okay . Yeah, I can do that."

"Good,"Catra nodded back, reaching a claw up to grab the zipper on Adora's sports bra and give it a playful tug. "If you do a good job, maybe it can be a euphemism, too."

An intense blush rose in Adora's cheeks, flushing her face prettily and heightening the determination filling her eyes. "I *always* do a good job,"she asserted.

"I'll see about that,"Catra teased.

"You will," Adora promised.

Adora tightened the last screw and then stepped back, shutting the bathroom door and giving it a long look.

"Good as new," she declared, turning to grin proudly at Catra.

Catra raised an eyebrow, stepping forward to turn the doorknob back and forth and rattle it a bit before opening the door. She'd been watching Adora fix her door for the last half hour or so—putting it back on its hinges, making sure there was plenty of clearance on the top and bottom, taking the old, broken doorknob out and installing the new one—and she was sure she'd done as good of a job as she'd promised to. She'd sworn up and down during their date that afternoon that she knew *exactly* what Catra's door needed and exactly how to give it that, and it seemed it hadn't been a lie. Maybe not even the flirting Catra had assumed it was—maybe it really had just been facts.

Catra went inside the bathroom and shut the door again, assessing the other side of it and making sure the lock worked properly.

By the time she swung the door back open again, Adora's cocky confidence had tripled, her proud grin turning into a dark arrogance.

It was ridiculous how sexy it made her face look.

Catra leaned her shoulder against the doorframe, crossing her arms and allowing a fraction of how impressed and turned on she was to seep into her expression. "Looks decent to me," she nodded.

Adora raised a dark eyebrow, closing the distance between them and crossing her arms as well. "It looks amazing, you mean."

Catra rolled her eyes playfully, but she couldn't keep her tail from sweeping forward to hook around Adora's ankle. "It's still the same

ratty old door."

"With a gorgeous, new , sparkling doorknob," Adora added, "that *won't* jam the next time you or your friend decides to lock yourself in there."

"Whatever ," Catra teased, her fluency with comebacks faltering this close to Adora's beautiful face. "Thank you."

A genuine smile spread over Adora's face, and she uncrossed her hands to stretch one up to the doorframe so she could lean even closer without touching Catra yet. "You're welcome," she answered softly. "Was my work up to your standards?"

Catra blew a sigh of air from her lips, ignoring her thumping heart and acting like she had to take some time to consider the quality of her work. "Hmm, I guess so."

"You *guessso* ?" Adora looked wounded. "That's not the kind of glowing review I'm used to getting from my clients."

Catra raised both eyebrows playfully. "Do you fix doors for free for poor lesbians after going on a date with them often?"

Adora's expression rearranged itself into determination as she shook her head. "No, no. Free post-date door services are only under my wifely duties package."

Catra poorly suppressed a laugh. "Your *wifelyduties* package?"

"Yeah," Adora nodded, "you know . Fixing doorsunclogging sinks… mowing lawns, cleaning pools, breaking beds, dealing with bugs, those types of things. Wifely duties."

Catra's mouth quirked up with a smirk. "Wow," she let herself sound impressed. "That's a lot of things."

Adora shrugged playfully. "I have a lot to offer."

Catra couldn't stop her smile from spreading. "We're already married, Adora," she teased. "You don't have to try so hard to get me."

"I'm not trying to *get* you," Adora said, her lips turning down into something more serious. "I'm trying to *keep* you."

"You want to keep me?" Catra asked, the quiet words escaping before she could stop them.

"If you'll let me," Adora nodded, leaning down. "I can get more Funyuns if you need me to propose again. Or peach rings, or a ring pop, or something."

"You're such an idiot," Catra grinned, leaning up.

"As long as I'm yours," Adora breathed against her lips, and that was it.

Catra wrapped a hand against her jaw and pulled her down, meeting Adora with gentle but insistent pressure. Her familiar taste flooded Catra with a buzzing warmth from her head down to her toes, and as soon as they came apart for a breath, they met again, better angled and more desperate. Their second kiss quickly escalated into a hungrier third, Catra biting at her bottom lip and Adora sweeping her tongue out to taste her, and the desire consumed them.

Catra wrapped her hands around Adora's shoulders and pushed, turning her flat against the wall just outside of the bathroom. Adora hit it with a soft noise and dropped her hands to Catra's waist, wrapping around it and guiding her forward.

Catra arched up into Adora's body, heart reaching for something only she could give her, and she could swear she felt the same desperate reach returned in the way that Adora tugged her closer.

As they lost themselves in each other, Catra had the fleeting thought that she had never expected to be so grateful to Perfuma for getting

wasted and trapped inside her bathroom in the middle of the night.

Three Weeks Later

Glimmer picked the package up from the stoop of the station and checked the label.

"Holy shit!" she shouted, shifting it into one arm and throwing the front door open. *"Catra!"*

She raced down the hallway to their break room, setting it down on one of the tables and starting to try to rip it open.

"Catra!" Bow exclaimed, jumping up from the couch and joining her.

Scorpia perked up from the other end of the couch, and Mara and Huntara filtered in from their offices, watching curiously as Glimmer tore the cardboard box apart.

Inside were ten mugs, and she grabbed the first one she could find and held it aloft, victorious. *"Catra!"*

Everyone grabbed one, holding them up and admiring the artwork they'd had screen-printed onto it. It was a tiny sketch of a stick figure with a ponytail, a giant hair poof, and bulging arm muscles and boobs.

"*Wow*. It's amazing," Bow said, sounding a little teary-eyed.

"It's perfect," Glimmer agreed, looking up at everyone. "It's everything we hoped for."

Mara raised her mug high over the center of the table, nodding with the command that only a Fire Chief could have. "To the Adora mugs," she announced.

"To the Horde!" everyone chorused, clinking their mugs together.

"Oh, man. She's gonna kill us when she sees these," Bow said quietly but with an absurd amount of delight.

"She sure is," Huntara nodded, grinning with victory.

"I can't wait," Glimmer agreed.

End Notes

The idea for this came from this video: https://www.tiktok.com/@meliasamson/video/7167940900047994

I was constantly laughing while I wrote this, and I hope you were laughing while you read it! A million thanks to my beta as always, and many many thanks to one of my dear friends, who helped me with the concussion testing protocols and how to turn them into ridiculous flirting. Let me know your favorite part in the comments, and thank you so much for reading! <3

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